

6.4 Nuclear and particle physics

This section provides knowledge and understanding of the atom, nucleus, fundamental particles, radioactivity, fission and fusion.

Nuclear power stations provide a significant fraction of the energy needs of many countries. They are expensive; governments have to make difficult

decisions when building new ones. The building of nuclear power stations can be used to evaluate the benefits and risks to society (HSW9). Ethical, environmental and decision making issues may also be discussed (HSW10 and HSW12). The development of the atomic model also addresses issues of scientific development and validation (HSW7, 11).